JHANAVI SANKAR

jsankar@andrew.cmu.edu | (412) 512-8953 | www.linkedin.com/in/jhanavisankar | Portfolio: https://jhsankar.github.io/

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College
Master of Science in Public Policy & Management GPA: 3.90
Delhi University, Lady Shri Ram College 2021
Bachelor of Arts, Honors, Sociology

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

AI Governance & Strategy: Responsible AI principles, NIST AI RMF, benchmarking, model risk assessment
Analytical Skills & Tools: Research synthesis, quasi-experimental methods, regression analysis, executive-ready deliverables, stakeholder engagement, PowerPoint, Excel, Power BI, Tableau, SQL, R, Python, ArcGIS Pro
Relevant Courses: Operationalizing AI, AI Agent Lab, Interactive Data Science, Data Science & Machine Learning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Plus Lab, Carnegie Mellon University August 2025 – Present
Research Assistant (Professor Danielle Thomas)
- Synthesize quantitative findings on an AI-enabled product into structured insights and executive-ready briefings, enabling practitioners and researchers to act on performance and equity data
- Model intervention impact using regression and quasi-experimental methods in R (R^2 0.60–0.85), translating analytical results into program strategy and implementation recommendations

Pittsburgh Public Schools June 2025 – August 2025
Data and Reporting (Power BI Analytics)
- Engineered SQL pipelines integrating four administrative datasets and built Power BI analytics on 5M+ rows spanning 54 school sites, enabling district leadership to identify high-risk segments and operational interventions
- Authored three executive-ready insight reports translating complex operational data into decision-ready briefings for senior leadership

Teach for India May 2022 – May 2024
Fellow Advisor and Fellow
- Coordinated cross-functional implementation of state-aligned initiatives across schools, partner organizations, and government stakeholders, navigating competing priorities under tight delivery timelines
- Designed and facilitated leadership development and training programming for 50+ practitioners, driving an 80% improvement in reported team communication effectiveness
- Developed 90+ standardized resources and adoption tools, translating strategic policy guidance into operational materials for frontline team

PROJECTS

KM Strategies Group, Agentic AI for Public Good January 2026 – May 2026
- Architected a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) grantmaking tool ingesting public data sources including ProPublica Explorer and IRS 990 data to surface aligned funders and rank them against nonprofit project criteria
- Drafted an AI governance framework for responsible AI adoption, integrating risk assessment, data privacy, and bias mitigation principles into policy standards and tool-usage guidance
- Conducted a structured evaluation of tool performance against client use cases, synthesizing findings into recommendations for responsible deployment at scale

Responsible AI Risk Assessment, Healthcare Algorithms January 2026 – March 2026
- Designed an enterprise-style AI governance framework using the NIST AI Risk Management Framework, including a Red-Amber-Green risk-classification system, threshold-based deactivation procedures, risk controls, and continuous monitoring approaches
- Diagnosed bias in an AI model affecting 200M users, quantifying the failure (demographic parity ratio of 0.38; 15% opportunity gap), producing a governance template consisting of a technical assessment and operational controls
- Mapped governance roles and accountability structures across clinical, vendor, compliance, and leadership stakeholders, defining a three-lines-of-defense oversight model and escalation protocols

AI and the Workforce, Policy Innovation Lab × U.S. Census Bureau October 2024 – December 2024
- Conducted current-state analysis and benchmarking of AI adoption trends across occupational roles, integrating O*NET task data with federal survey data to build a workforce analytics dataset
- Coordinated stakeholder interviews and synthesized findings into structured requirements, tracking tools, and implementation planning artifacts for a public-sector AI initiative